

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS

HOST GUIDE

The Golden Whisk Mystery

A Kids Detective Party Game

Ages 8–12

6–12 players

60–90 min

No murder

Chief Inspector Crumb's Casebook

Everything you need to host, from one week before to the final cheer. No spoilers inside: this file never names the thief or gives the puzzle answers.



THE SIX CORE SUSPECTS · EVERY KID GETS A ROLE



Clue & Candle Games

US LETTER + A4

Welcome, Inspector

READ THIS FIRST

Thank you for hosting! This guide walks you through everything, even if you have never run a mystery party before. You don't need to act or memorize anything. You read five short scripts, hand out cards, and keep the fun moving.

The story in one minute



It is the afternoon of the Sprinkle Street Cake Contest. The prize is the Golden Whisk, a shiny old gold-painted whisk that sits on a velvet cushion in the Display Tent. Judging starts at 3:00 pm. But at 2:40 pm the cushion is empty! All that is left is a trail of sugar-dust footprints and a mystery note. Chief Inspector Crumb has closed Sprinkle Street. Nobody goes home until the Golden Whisk is found.

How the game works



PART	WHAT HAPPENS
Welcome	You read Script 1. Each child reads page 2 of their booklet quietly: who they are, their little secret, and where they were.
Round 1	Script 2. You hand out Evidence 1–3 and Puzzle P1. Kids read Round 1, share clues and ask questions.
Round 2	Script 3, Evidence 4–6, Puzzle P2, Round 2. Secrets start to come out.
Round 3	Script 4, Evidence 7–9, Puzzle P3, Round 3. The last clues fall into place.
Puzzles	Solve a puzzle, whisper the answer to you, and earn a BONUS clue (E10, E11 or E12).
The end	Everyone votes. You read Script 5 from file 99. Awards!

GOLDEN RULES (READ THESE OUT AT THE START)

- Read a Round only when the Inspector says so.
- You may fib about your own little secret, but never about the evidence cards.
- Anyone can ask anyone anything. Be kind!
- Nobody looks at another person's booklet.

Getting Ready

TICK AS YOU GO



One week before



- ☐ Pick a date. Choose the full game (85 minutes) or the quick game (60 minutes).
- ☐ Count the children and find your row in the casting table on the next page.
- ☐ Send invitations from file 02, or copy the text version into a message to parents.
- ☐ Decide who plays which character. Hand out the booklets freely.



Two or three days before



- ☐ Print using the print list in file 00. Print booklets **single-sided**.
- ☐ Cut, fold and seal the Round 2 and Round 3 slips (2 per booklet, about 10 minutes for 6 kids).
- ☐ Cut out the evidence cards, hint cards, name tags, badges and ballots.
- ☐ Put E1–E3, E4–E6 and E7–E9 into three envelopes marked Round 1, Round 2 and Round 3.
- ☐ Put E10, E11 and E12 in a “BONUS” envelope and keep it in your pocket.
- ☐ Read file 99 if you’d like to know the answer, then hide it away from the kids.



On the day



- ☐ Set out the table signs and the paper Golden Whisk from file 36 (optional).
- ☐ Put a pencil, a name tag and a Detective Notebook at each place.
- ☐ Keep this guide, the three envelopes, the puzzle cards and the hint cards by you.
- ☐ Plan snacks for between rounds (ideas on page 11).

Casting

6 TO 12 KIDS

KIDS	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Booklets	10–15	10–16	10–17	10–18	10–19	10–20	10–21
Who plays	Core six	Core six + 16	Core six + 16–17	Core six + 16–18	Core six + 16–19	Core six + 16–20	Core six + 16–21

The grown-up host plays **Chief Inspector Crumb**. Every child gets one booklet. Hand them out freely: any child can play any character, and every name and booklet works for boys and girls alike.

- Booklets **10–15** are the six **core** characters. They are always played.
- Add optional characters in number order: 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21.
- If a character isn't played, they simply weren't at the contest today. Kids skip any question that names someone who isn't there.

Ages: 8–12. A 7-year-old can play with a grown-up or older sibling reading along; under 7 is not recommended.

13 to 16 kids: share a character



Use all 12 booklets. Then pair up the extra children with a character, starting with booklet 10, then 11, 12 and so on. Print a second copy of that booklet. The pair plays the character together as “partners,” shares the clues and casts one vote.

Big groups (14–24 kids): team mode

Classes, clubs, camps

- Make 3 or 4 teams of 4 to 6 kids. Each team plays the six core characters (booklets 10–15) at its own table, with its own evidence cards (30) and puzzle cards (31).
- You read each script once, to the whole room. A team that solves a puzzle earns its own BONUS card.
- Teams of 4 or 5: deal the six booklets out at random, so one or two kids hold two booklets and read both.
- Print per team: 6 booklets (24 pages) + 30 (3) + 31 (3). The Detective Notebook (35) has no answers in it, so you can reprint it for the next activity.

Timetables

FULL GAME OR QUICK GAME

Full game • 85 minutes



PART	WHAT YOU DO	MIN
Arrival and name tags	Kids arrive, get a name tag, a Junior Detective badge, a pencil and a Detective Notebook.	10
Script 1 • Welcome	Read Script 1. Kids read page 2 quietly, then each says their name and role.	10
Round 1 • The Empty Stand	Read Script 2. Hand out E1–E3 and Puzzle P1. Kids open Round 1.	15
Round 2 • Sticky Clues	Read Script 3. Hand out E4–E6 and Puzzle P2. Kids open Round 2.	15
Round 3 • The Final Taste Test	Read Script 4. Hand out E7–E9 and Puzzle P3. Kids open Round 3.	15
Accusation	Quiet thinking time, then everyone fills in a ballot.	10
Reveal and awards	Read Script 5 from file 99, score ballots, give awards.	10
Total		85

Quick game • 60 minutes



PART	WHAT YOU DO	MIN
Arrival	Name tags and notebooks.	5
Script 1 • Welcome	Short version; skip introductions.	5
Round 1	Script 2, E1–E3, P1.	12
Round 2	Script 3, E4–E6, P2.	12
Round 3	Script 4, E7–E9, P3.	12
Accusation	Ballots.	6
Reveal	Script 5, awards.	8
Total		60

QUICK-GAME TIPS

Ask kids to read pages 1 and 2 of their booklets at the door. Set a phone timer for each round. Use hint cards early so the puzzles move fast.

Script 1 • Welcome

BEFORE ROUND 1

BEFORE YOU READ

Every child has a name tag, a badge, a pencil, a Detective Notebook and their own booklet. Read the four golden rules from page 2 first.

READ ALOUD AS CHIEF INSPECTOR CRUMB

Good afternoon, detectives! I am Chief Inspector Crumb, and I am very glad you are here.

Today is the Sprinkle Street Cake Contest. The prize is the Golden Whisk, the shiniest trophy in town.

But at twenty to three, the cushion was empty! All we found were sugar-dust footprints and a mystery note.

Nobody is hurt and nothing is spooky. But somebody here knows exactly where that Whisk went.

Open your case file to page 2 and read it quietly. It tells you who you are, where you were, and one little secret.

Now, one at a time, stand up and tell us your name, your job, and one thing you love about cake.

Listen carefully. Every word could be a clue!

IF THE ROOM GOES QUIET

- Go around in booklet order (10, 11, 12...). Each child reads the name and job from page 1.
- Ask: "Where were you when the Whisk went missing?"

Script 2 • The Empty Stand

ROUND 1

BEFORE YOU READ

Have the Round 1 envelope (E1–E3), Puzzle P1 and hint cards P1 and R1 ready. Lay the evidence face up in the middle.

READ ALOUD AS CHIEF INSPECTOR CRUMB

Detectives, my team has searched the Display Tent. Here are the first three clues: Evidence 1, 2 and 3.

Who would like to read one out loud? Read slowly, so everyone hears every word.

Now turn to page 3 of your booklet and read Round 1 only. Keep your sealed slips closed.

Tell people what your booklet says to tell, and ask your two questions.

My sergeant also found a secret code: Puzzle P1. Solve it, then whisper the answer to me for a BONUS clue.

Write what you learn in your Detective Notebook. You have fifteen minutes. Go!

IF THE ROOM GOES QUIET

- Ask: “When was the Golden Whisk last seen?”
- Ask: “What is on the cushion in E2?”
- Invite the quietest detective to ask the first question.

Script 3 • Sticky Clues

ROUND 2

BEFORE YOU READ

Have the Round 2 envelope (E4–E6), Puzzle P2 and hint cards P2 and R2 ready. A small mirror or a phone camera helps with P2.

READ ALOUD AS CHIEF INSPECTOR CRUMB

Well done, detectives. Now the clues are getting sticky!

Here are Evidence 4, 5 and 6. Who will read them out?

Break your Round 2 seal now and open the slip! Some of you have a secret to confess.

Share your clues, ask your questions, and try your mission.

And here is Puzzle P2, a message that only a mirror can read. Solve it for another BONUS clue.

Remember: you may fib about your own secret, but never about the evidence. Fifteen minutes!

IF THE ROOM GOES QUIET

- Ask: “Which way do the footprints go?”
- Ask: “Has anyone’s story changed?”
- Ask each detective to name one person they now trust, and why.

Script 4 • The Final Taste Test

ROUND 3

BEFORE YOU READ

Have the Round 3 envelope (E7–E9), Puzzle P3, hint cards P3 and R3, and the ballots ready.

READ ALOUD AS CHIEF INSPECTOR CRUMB

Detectives, the judges are waiting, and so is the last evidence: Evidence 7, 8 and 9.

Please read them out loud.

Break your Round 3 seal now and open the slip! This is your last chance to share, ask and solve.

Here is Puzzle P3, a map of Sprinkle Street. Follow the steps for the last BONUS clue.

Put every card from all three rounds in the middle, and compare your notes.

When the time is up, each of you will tell me who has the Golden Whisk, how, and why. Fifteen minutes!

IF THE ROOM GOES QUIET

- Ask: “Who was away from the Contest Kitchen?”
- Ask: “Which card has gold in it?”
- Ask each detective to point to the clue that helped them most.

Puzzles, Hints & the Vote

HOW TO RUN THEM

Puzzle cards (file 31)



1. Hand out one puzzle card each round, at the end of the script. Kids can work on it alone or together.
2. When someone thinks they've solved it, they whisper the answer to you. The answers are on page 4 of file 99. A close answer counts.
3. Correct? Give the whole group the BONUS card for that puzzle: P1 earns E10, P2 earns E11, P3 earns E12. Read it out and put it with the other evidence.
4. Keep a tally of who solved each puzzle, for the Puzzle Champion award.

Hint cards (file 32)



There are six: one for each puzzle (P1, P2, P3) and one for each round (R1, R2, R3). If kids are stuck for 3–4 minutes, read a hint card aloud or hand it over. Hints point the way but never name anyone.

The vote and the reveal



1. Give every child a ballot (file 34) and three quiet minutes with their notes.
2. Each child writes who has the Golden Whisk, how, why, and their best clue (an E number).
3. Collect the ballots in a bowl, then read **Script 5** from file 99 out loud.
4. Score the ballots with the rules in file 99 and give the awards from file 36.

Hosting Tips & Snacks



Hosting tips



- **Shy kids:** ask them to read an evidence card aloud, or let them whisper their question to you and you say it for them. A partner can help.
- **“I don’t want to be the thief!”** Tell every child before page 2: being the sneaky one is a fun acting job, like playing the wolf in a school play. The ending is happy: the Whisk comes back, there’s a big “sorry,” and everyone keeps playing. Never swap booklets after page 2 has been read.
- **Keep it moving:** when a round’s timer ends, move on. The clues still work.
- **Fibbing:** kids may fib about their own small secret, but never about the evidence.
- **Costumes are optional.** An apron, a hat or a prop is plenty.
- **Late arrival?** Hand over the booklet, give two minutes for page 2, and point at the evidence on the table.
- **Someone can’t come?** A core booklet (10–15) goes to a child who was going to play an optional character; leave that optional character out. A missing optional booklet is simply left out.



Snack ideas



SNACK	IN A SENTENCE
Sprinkle cupcakes	Plain cupcakes with a bowl of sprinkles, so every detective decorates one.
“Clue” cookies	Cookies with a letter iced on each one. Spell out CASE CLOSED at the end.
Pink “evidence” lemonade	Lemonade with a splash of berry juice, served in cups labeled with E numbers.

Serve snacks between rounds, or bring out the birthday cake after the reveal as the “final taste test.”



Printing & Cutting



Printing



- Use the print list in file 00. Print at 100% (“Actual size”).
- **Booklets: print single-sided**, so later rounds can’t show through the paper.
- Black-and-white works well for everything. Color is a bonus.
- File 22 has all 12 booklets in one file for quick printing. Print it or files 10–21, not both.



Cutting and folding



- **Booklet pages 3 and 4:** cut out the Round 2 and Round 3 slips and their round seals. Fold each slip in half, words inside, and tape the seal on. Keep the slips with the rest of the booklet.
- **Evidence cards (file 30):** cut on the dashed lines. Page 3 has card backs: print it on the back of pages 1 and 2 if you like, so cards can lie face down.
- **Puzzle cards (file 31):** one per page, no cutting.
- **Hint cards, name tags, badges, ballots:** cut on the dashed lines. Tape or pin badges to clothes.
- **Table signs (file 36):** cut out, then fold on the dotted line so they stand up.

ENVELOPES

Label four envelopes: Round 1, Round 2, Round 3 and BONUS. That’s all the props you need.